

# Hilina Derese

*Business Analyst/Business  
Director*



+14083809934



[gizawhilina@gmail.com](mailto:gizawhilina@gmail.com)



[www.abbyssinianlivingroom.com](http://www.abbyssinianlivingroom.com)



990 Almedan Lake Dr, 95123  
San Jose, CA



## About Me

**Accomplished and results-oriented business executive with more than a decade of experience in overseeing operations, personnel, and customer experience within the hospitality, food service, and global business sectors. Demonstrated ability to enhance profitability, sustain operational excellence, and cultivate high-performing teams. Proficient in profit and loss management, employee training, strategic planning, and adherence to health and safety regulations. Experienced in fostering robust community and stakeholder relationships while ensuring uniform brand quality and customer satisfaction.**

## Expertise Skill

- Innovation Management and entrepreneurship.
- Restaurant & Café Operations Management.
- Project management
- Staff Training & Team Leadership
- Customer Service Excellence
- Health, Safety & Sanitation Compliance.
- International Business consulting
- Strategic Planning & Business Growth.
- International expertise in Global Business .

## TECHNICALSKILLS

- BI Tools: T-SQL, Tableau,
- Reporting, Analytics,
- Dashboard.
- Microsoft office:
- Word, Excel, Power point
- Databases: SQL Server,
- T-SQL, Tableau, Power
- Orange

## Work Experience

- **BUSINESS DIRECTOR / ENTREPRENEUR  
Abyssinian Livingroom (Nordic Abyssinia Oy), Finland  
September 2010 – December 2024**
  - Directed all aspects of operations for a busy café and restaurant serving diverse clientele in Western Finland, achieving an 85% year-over-year gross profit increase.
  - Managed staff recruitment, training, and scheduling to ensure efficient deployment and excellent service standards.
  - Oversaw daily opening and closing operations, inventory management, product availability, and vendor relationships.
  - Ensured compliance with health, safety, and sanitation regulations while maintaining exceptional customer satisfaction levels.
  - Analyzed P&L statements to identify cost-saving opportunities and implemented strategic initiatives to boost revenue.
  - Negotiated supplier contracts, delivery schedules, and pricing to support profitability and reliable supply chain operations.
  - Created and introduced new menu items and café concepts, enhancing customer experience and brand loyalty.

# Education

- **2021–Present**  
**Doctorate in Business Administration (DBA) – Westcliff University, Irvine, CA**
- **2024**  
**Technical Project Management.**
- **2016**  
**M.Sc. in Business Administration – Aalto University, Finland**
- **2009**  
**B.A. in International Business – Vaasa University of Applied Sciences, Finland**

## **BUSINESS CONSULTANT**

**Finn Partnership – Helsinki, Finland**

**September 2014 – April 2019**

- Provided business advisory services to international energy and engineering firms to promote cross-border trade and partnerships.
- Analyzed financial data and developed strategic growth plans for client companies with annual turnovers exceeding \$200,000.
- Coordinated partnership meetings and business development trips, fostering collaboration between Finnish and East African enterprises.
- Developed project budgets, reports, and financial evaluations ensuring transparency and accountability.
- Supported companies in aligning operational practices with sustainability and profitability objectives.

## **INNOVATION MANAGER**

**United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) – Addis Ababa, Ethiopia**

**May 2015 – February 2016**

- Spearheaded innovation initiatives to streamline development projects, resulting in cost savings of \$1.2M.
- Facilitated stakeholder engagement meetings and partnerships among entrepreneurs, academia, and government bodies.
- Designed data collection and reporting systems to improve project transparency and efficiency.
- Coordinated training and team collaboration activities, emphasizing innovation, inclusivity, and continuous improvement.
- Championed initiatives promoting community engagement and sustainable project outcomes.